



RIPHAH
INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY



RIPHAH
DEPARTMENT OF ISLAMIC STUDIES

Ethics and Society

Department of Islamic Studies, Faculty of Social Sciences and Humanities, Riphah International University Islamabad, Pakistan
Email : life.living@riphah.edu.pk Contact # +92,320,7863888



Ethics and Society

- Objectives of *shari'ah*
- Personal ethics
- Social ethics
- Economic ethics



Objectives of the lecture

- To study the objectives of *Shari'ah* for *ethical principle and moral values*
- To know the personal ethics to develop the personality traits
- To be aware of the social ethics for the welfare of society
- To learn the economic ethics for economic empowerment



Objectives of Islamic Shari'ah

The Shari'ah shapes Islamic society in a way conducive to the unfettered growth of good, righteousness and truth in every sphere of human activity. At the same time it removes all the impediments along the path to goodness. And it attempts to eradicate corruption from its social scheme by prohibiting evil, by removing the causes of its appearance and growth, by closing the inlets through which it creeps into a society and by adopting deterrent measures to check its occurrence.

The Islamic Way of Life by Sayyid Abu A'la Mawdudi, p. 8

<https://www.islamicstudies.info/literature/wayoflife.htm>



Objectives of Islamic Sharia

The main objectives of the Shariah are to ensure that human life is based on marufat (good) and to cleanse it of munkarat (evils). The terms marufat denotes all the qualities that have always been accepted as 'good' by the human conscience. Conversely, the word munkarat denotes all those qualities that have always been condemned by human nature as evil. In short, the marufat are in harmony with human nature and the munkarat are against nature. The Shariah gives precise definitions of marufat and munkarat, clearly indicating the standards of goodness to which individuals and society should aspire.

The Islamic Way of Life by Sayyid Abu A'la Mawdudi, p. 8

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Primary Islamic Universal Ethical Values

Unity
in Life

and Cosmos (*tawhid*)

Equity, Justice, Fairness
(*'adl*)

Protection and Promotion of Life (*nafs*)

Protection of Reason (*'aql*)

Preservation of Religio-Cultural Freedom (*din*)

Protection and Dignity of Gene and Genealogy (*nasl*)

Protection of Property (*mal*)



Objectives of Islamic Shariah

The preservation of religion:

Religion is the sum of beliefs, rituals and rules commanded by Allah Almighty to regulate people's relationship to their Lord and relationships with each other.

The preservation of the life:

Islam has not only protected the soul from being killed or wasted but also established a set of rules to ensure its welfare spiritually and humanly that is to secure surviving needs such as food, marriage, shelter, drinks and clothing as well as establishing rules that deny and forbid the all means of self's distractions.

It is through life that Mankind is able to maintain or preserve all of Allah Almighty's provisions and principles.

- Outlines of Islamic Jurisprudence by Imran Ahsan Nyyazi, p.212-214

https://books.google.com.pk/books?id=ivKxDwAAQBAJ&printsec=frontcover&dq=islamic+jurisprudence&hl=en&sa=X&redir_esc=y#v=onepage&q=islamic%20jurisprudence&f=false



Objectives of Islamic Sharia

The preservation of the mind/intellect

Allah Most High has commanded us to preserve our minds thus has forbid all the means to disable it through the toxicities, alcohols.

That is Allah Almighty has granted and distinguished humans from all other creatures by the grace of the mind, which means the ability to distinguish and making choices, and solving the difficulties faced in life.

The preservation of lineage/offspring

Shariah persevering human's offspring, Shari'ah has legitimized marriage and reproduction, and for the sake of protecting it, Shari'ah has forbade adultery and assigned a legal punishment (had) for whoever commit it. This is done for protection of lineage.

- Outlines of Islamic Jurisprudence by Imran Ahsan Nyyazi, p.212-214



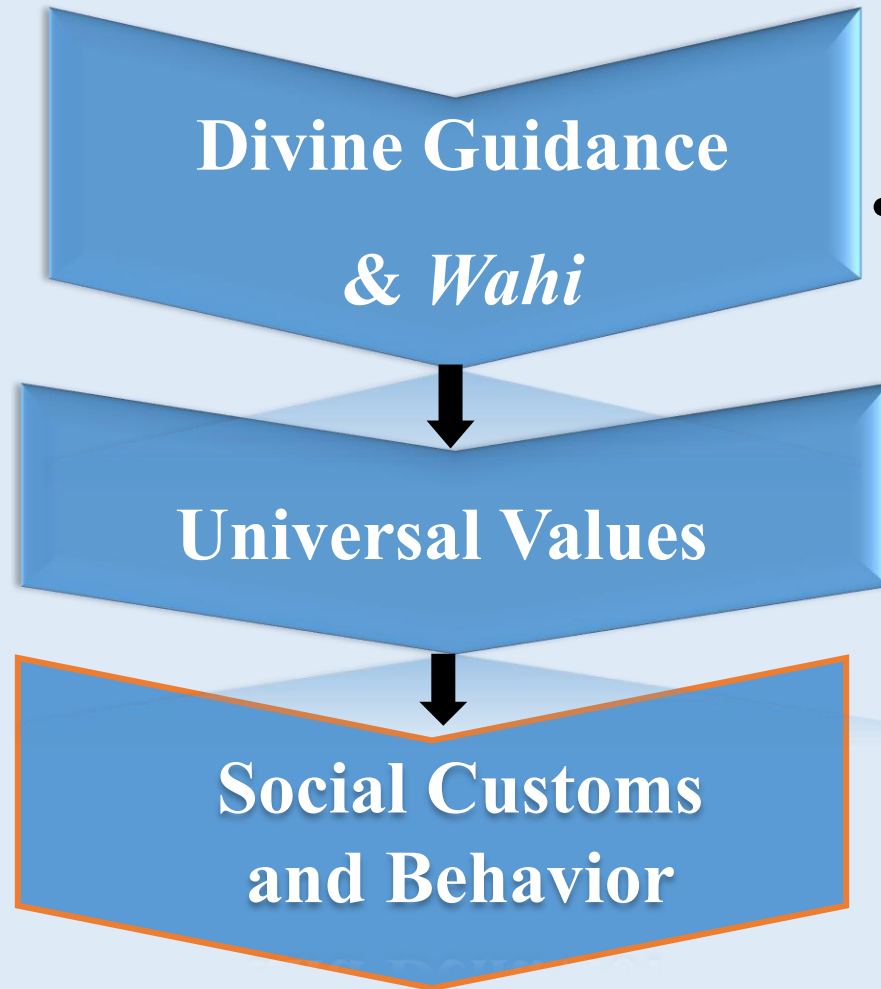
Objectives of Islamic Sharia

The preservation of wealth/property

- Shari'ah has commanded for the purpose of preserving human's wealth the pursuit of earning a living and permitted transactions and exchanges and trade.
- Shari'ah also, for the sake of preserving wealth as well, forbid and placed punishments upon theft, deception, treason and consuming people's wealth unjustly, in addition to discouraging the squandering of money.
- Money, as well as everything, belongs to Allah almighty, who has granted humans the status of successors on earth, and so they are commanded to preserve such grace not to waste it.



Islamic universal paradigm for all mankind



- Divine guidance from beyond guides through *wahi* (revelation) in an objective manner and not in a subjective, intuitive, mystical, purely rational or personal judgmental way.



Personal and social Ethics

Equality of Mankind

God created a human couple to herald the beginning of the life of mankind on earth, and everybody living in the world today originates from this couple. Islam says that if there is any real difference between man and man it cannot be one of race, colour, country or language, but of ideas, beliefs and principles. On the basis of this fundamental tenet, Islam seeks to build a principled and ideological society very different from the racial, nationalistic and parochial societies existing in the world today.

The Islamic Way of Life by Sayyid Abu A'la Mawdudi, p. 24-25

<https://www.islamicstudies.info/literature/wayoflife.htm>

Personal and social Ethics

- **Institution of the Family**

The foremost and fundamental institution of human society is the family unit. A family is established by the coming together of a man and a woman, and their contact brings into existence a new generation. This then produces ties of kinship and community, which, in turn, gradually develop further ties. The family is an instrument of continuity which prepares the succeeding generation to serve human civilization and to discharge its social obligations with devotion, sincerity and enthusiasm. This institution does not merely recruit cadets for the maintenance of human culture, but positively desires that those who are to come will be better members of society. In this respect the family can be truly called the source of the progress, development, prosperity and strength of human civilisation. Islam therefore devotes much attention to the issues relating to the family and strives to establish it on the healthiest and strongest possible foundations.

The Islamic Way of Life by Sayyid Abu A'la Mawdudi, p. 25-26

<https://www.islamicstudies.info/literature/wayoflife.htm>

Personal and social Ethics

- **Relatives and Neighbors**

After the limited circle of the family, the next social sphere is that of kinship and blood relationship. Islam wants all those who are related through common parents, common brothers and sisters or marriage to be affectionate, cooperative and helpful to each other. In many places in the Qur 'an good treatment of the near relations is enjoined.

The Islamic Way of Life by Sayyid Abu A'la Mawdudi, p. 25-26

<https://www.islamicstudies.info/literature/wayoflife.htm>



Personal and social Ethics

Islamic ethics and morality gives equal importance to social conduct of man in society. It wants to build human conduct and behavior on *ma'ruf* (good), *sidq* (truthfulness) and *ukhuwah* (brotherhood of faith).

"وَاعْتَصِمُوا بِحَبْلِ اللَّهِ جَمِيعًا وَلَا تَفَرَّقُوا ۚ وَاذْكُرُوا نِعْمَتَ اللَّهِ عَلَيْكُمْ إِذْ كُنْتُمْ أَعْدَاءً فَأَلَّفَ بَيْنَ قُلُوبِكُمْ فَأَصْبَحْتُمْ بِنِعْمَتِهِ إِخْوَانًا ۚ وَكُنْتُمْ عَلَىٰ شَفَا حُفْرَةٍ مِّنَ النَّارِ فَأَنْقَذَكُم مِّنْهَا ۚ كَذَٰلِكَ يُبَيِّنُ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ آيَاتِهِ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَهْتَدُونَ".

“Hold fast together to the cable (*Book*) of Allah. And be not divided, remember the blessing that Allah bestowed upon you: you were once enemies, then He brought your hearts together, so that through His blessing you became brothers...



Personal and social Ethics

• وَلْتَكُنْ مِنْكُمْ أُمَّةٌ يَدْعُونَ إِلَى الْخَيْرِ وَيَأْمُرُونَ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ وَيَنْهَوْنَ عَنِ الْمُنْكَرِ وَأُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْمُفْلِحُونَ

“And from amongst you there must be a community who call people to all that is good (*khayr*) and will enjoin the doing of all that is right (*ma'ruf*) and will forbid the doing of all that is wrong (*munkar*).”

(*Al-i-Imran, 3:103-104*)

To encourage people towards good and khair pro-actively

To halt people from wrongdoing and munkar at every cost

To make a group of people to sustain the moral values in the community

Personal & social Ethics

كُنْتُمْ خَيْرَ أُمَّةٍ أُخْرِجَتْ لِلنَّاسِ تَأْمُرُونَ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ وَتَنْهَوْنَ عَنِ الْمُنْكَرِ وَتُؤْمِنُونَ بِاللَّهِ ۚ وَلَوْ آمَنَ أَهْلُ الْكِتَابِ لَكَانَ خَيْرًا لَّهُمْ مِنْهُمْ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ وَ أَكْثَرُهُمُ الْفَاسِقُونَ.

“You are now the best *ummah* brought forth for mankind. You enjoin what is right (*ma‘ruf*) and forbid what is wrong (*munkar*) and believe in Allah”

(*Al-Imran, 3:110*)

- The duty of Muslim Ummah to promote ethical values for all
- Social ethical leadership through moral excellence
- Realization of right (*ma‘ruf*) and elimination of evil and wrong (*munkar*) as a social obligation.



Summary:

- Ethics are important not only in business but in academics and society as well because it is an essential part of the foundation on which a civilized society is built.
- Human actions are not supposed to be meaningless (*'abath*), but based on good (*ma'ruf*), virtue (*birr*), and permissible (*halal*) therefore essentially ethical. If otherwise, such actions will fall in the category of negative and bad (*munkar*), sinful (*sa'iyah*), undesirable (*makruh*) and prohibited (*haram*).
- Islam has not only protected the soul from being killed or wasted but also established a set of rules to ensure its welfare spiritually and humanly that is to secure surviving needs such as food, marriage, shelter, drinks and clothing as well as establishing rules that deny and forbid the all means of self's distractions.



Summary:

- Reference Books:
- Outlines of Islamic Jurisprudence by Imran Ahsan Nyyazi

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